



MentorMAMA

Better mentorship. Better outcomes.

BRAND GUIDELINES

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Why MentorMAMA exists

The core problem

Clinical mentorship quality in maternity units depends on which mentor a student happens to get — not on any system designed to make that experience consistent. Some students receive excellent guidance. Others receive almost none. The difference is luck, not design.

Brand purpose

MentorMAMA exists so that good mentorship doesn't depend on which mentor a student happens to get.

Vision

A future where the quality of a student's clinical mentorship is determined by the system supporting them, not by chance.

Mission

To give clinical mentors the structure, training, and tools to mentor well in minutes, not hours — and to give universities and facilities visibility into mentorship quality without adding to mentors' workload.

Who the brand is built around

The mentor is the bottleneck and the primary adoption audience. An already-overworked person is being asked to do one more thing — the brand has to make mentorship feel *lighter*, not like additional paperwork. Student transformation is the outcome the brand proves to universities and partners; mentor relief is what it has to deliver day-to-day.

The big idea

Structure, not paperwork.

Positioning

Positioning statement

MentorMAMA is a mobile-first mentorship support tool for maternity units, helping clinical mentors guide students consistently without adding to their workload. It is not a hospital information system, and not another health NGO project — it's a practical tool mentors actually want to open.

What MentorMAMA is not

- An electronic medical record or hospital management system
- A compliance tool built to police or rank mentors
- A replacement for human mentorship
- A generic learning management system

Scope today, room to grow

NOW

Maternity-focused

Language, naming, and messaging stay specific to midwifery clinical placement, matching the pilot and the evidence base.

LATER

Architected to extend

Data structures, roles, and module naming avoid maternity-only terms where possible, so the product can extend to other clinical disciplines without a rebrand.

Naming decision

The name MentorMAMA is retained. Maternity-specific language stays in product-facing copy and visuals. It is kept out of the structural/data layer. This decision should only be revisited if the team scopes a second clinical discipline.

What we stand for

Each value below includes a behavioral test — a value isn't real unless it would make the team say no to something.

Mentor time is sacred

If a feature adds more than a few minutes to a mentor's day, it gets redesigned or cut — regardless of how useful it would be for reporting.

Visibility, not surveillance

Dashboards exist to help managers support mentors and students, never to rank, shame, or punish individuals. No metric ships if it could be used to publicly discipline one mentor.

Consistency over charisma

The product should make an average mentor look reliable, not just make a great mentor look greater. Design favors the median user's daily reality.

Earn trust before asking for data

No field gets added to a form unless the team can explain, in one sentence, why it directly helps the student. "For reporting" alone is not a justification.

Design principles

Calm under pressure

The interface should reduce stress, not add to it.

One clear action

Every screen has one obvious next step — never five competing buttons.

Respect time

Mentors have minutes, not hours. Every interaction reflects that.

Who the brand is

Brand essence

The reliable colleague who has your back — the one who makes a hard shift feel manageable, without making you feel watched or judged.

Archetype

Caregiver–Sage hybrid. The warmth of a caregiver, paired with the clarity and competence of a sage. Not a Hero (too individualistic — contradicts structure-over-heroics), and not an Innovator or Magician (overclaims, before there's pilot evidence to back it).

Personality is, and is not

THE BRAND IS	THE BRAND IS NEVER
Calm	Cold or clinical
Direct	Bureaucratic
Warm	Saccharine or sentimental
Competent	Flashy or trend-chasing
Reassuring	Naggy or compliance-cop in tone

Brand metaphor

A guiding hand, not a guiding voice. The product doesn't lecture — it quietly supports.

How the brand speaks

Plain, practical, and respectful of the reader's time — closer to how a competent charge nurse talks to a new student than how a compliance manual reads.

Voice principles

- Short sentences. No "facilitate," "leverage," "stakeholder," "optimize."
- Say what to do, not just what the system tracks.
- Encouraging without being cheerful — this is a hospital, not a wellness app.
- Honest about effort. If something takes time, say so — that builds trust with a professionally skeptical audience.

In practice

INSTEAD OF	WE SAY
Digital Mentorship Monitoring System	Mentorship Hub
Session Documentation Module	Session Log
"Facilitate structured engagement tracking"	"Log this session in under 3 minutes"
"Dashboard Analytics Suite"	"Insights"

The mark



What it means

A single rising stroke begins uncertain and narrow, then curves into a steady, open base — a gesture of guidance arriving at a place of support, not a closed loop or a literal figure. The small circle marks the learner: present, in focus, held within a supportive structure rather than left to find their own way.

01

The rising stroke

Begins narrow and uncertain — the starting point of every student and every mentor's day.

02

The open curve

Widens into a steady, grounded base — structure replacing guesswork.

03

The circle

The learner — present and in focus, never reduced to a literal figure or icon.

04

The open end

The path continues beyond the mark — mentorship as an ongoing journey, not a finished transaction.

Lockups



PRIMARY LOCKUP — horizontal, full color



ICON ONLY
App icon, favicon, social
avatar



ON DARK
Navy backgrounds



MONOCHROME
Single-color print, watermarks

Minimum size

The icon should never render smaller than 24px in digital contexts, or 10mm in print. Below this, the inner circle loses legibility.

Clear space

Maintain clear space around the mark equal to the height of the icon's circle on all sides. No text, imagery, or competing elements should enter this space.

What not to do

The mark was deliberately kept abstract and non-literal. Protecting that clarity matters more than any single creative reuse.



Don't stretch or distort the proportions



Don't recolor outside the approved palette



Don't add drop shadows, gradients, or 3D effects



Don't rotate or flip the mark



Don't place on busy or low-contrast backgrounds



Don't redraw or trace the mark by hand



Don't close the open curve into a loop



Don't pair with a new tagline without approval

Always use approved source files

Use the master logo files only. Do not recreate the mark from screenshots, exports, or memory — small inconsistencies compound quickly across an app, a deck, and a printed handout.

Palette

Muted and credible, never bright or NGO-brochure in feel. Color should feel calm enough to sit comfortably on a phone screen during a busy shift.



Midnight Navy

#0D1B33

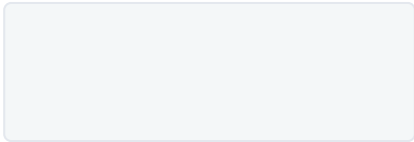
Primary — trust, stability, text



Guiding Teal

#1D8C8C

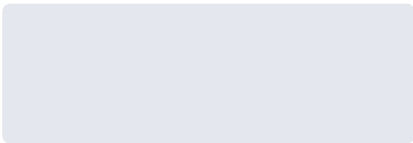
Secondary — accents, progress, links



Warm Mist

#F4F7F8

Backgrounds, cards, surfaces



Soft Stone

#E4E8EE

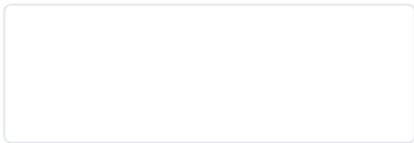
Dividers, borders, disabled states



Muted Terracotta

#D97757

Sparing use only — alerts, highlights



White

#FFFFFF

Primary canvas

Usage ratio

Navy and white should dominate every screen and document. Teal is the accent, not a second primary. Terracotta is reserved for the rare moment something needs deliberate attention — never decoration.

NAVY	WHITE / MIST	TEAL	TERRACOTTA
~30%	~50%	~15%	<5%

Type system

Modern humanist sans-serif throughout. Never condensed, never aggressively geometric — readable on a phone, in low light, by someone who has been on shift for eight hours.

Headings

Manrope — Bold / SemiBold

Used for page titles, section headers, and key statements. Confident without shouting.

Body & interface text

Inter — Regular / Medium

Used for body copy, forms, labels, and all UI text. Chosen for screen legibility at small sizes.

Hierarchy in practice

LEVEL	WEIGHT / SIZE	USE
Display	Manrope Bold, 28–34pt	Cover pages, hero statements
Heading	Manrope SemiBold, 18–22pt	Section titles
Subheading	Manrope SemiBold, 12–14pt	Card labels, form sections
Body	Inter Regular, 10–11pt	Paragraphs, descriptions
Caption	Inter Medium, 8–9pt	Metadata, timestamps, footnotes

Shape, image, motion

Shape language

Soft, rounded, continuous forms — never sharp or aggressive angles. Whitespace is treated as part of the interface, not empty space to be filled.

Photography

Real mentorship moments — teaching, listening, observation, hands-on learning — in authentic Kenyan clinical environments with natural lighting. No staged stock photography, no smiling-doctor-pointing-at-clipboard clichés, no posed handshakes.

Iconography

Rounded corners, consistent stroke weight (1.75px), simple and universal. Friendly but never playful or cartoonish.

Illustration

Soft, minimal, editorial line art when used at all. Subtle, never decorative for its own sake. Avoid cartoon figures.

Motion

Gentle, slow, and purposeful. Movement should reinforce calm and confidence — never flashy or attention-grabbing.

What we avoid

Bright primary colors, generic healthcare icons, crowded brochure layouts, heavy institutional branding. MentorMAMA should feel like a considered product that happens to operate in healthcare — not a temporary, donor-funded project.

Bringing it together

Three layers govern how the system applies across the product and any materials built on top of it.

Foundation — calm structure

Generous spacing, minimal color, clear hierarchy. Governs the overall layout of every screen and document — this is the baseline, always.

Human layer — warmth where it counts

Authentic photography, plain-spoken copy, and supportive onboarding moments sit on top of the calm foundation — applied at moments of relationship, not throughout every screen.

Structured layer — clarity for data

Dashboards, reports, and forms follow stricter grid and alignment rules for density and scannability — applied specifically to data-heavy surfaces, not the whole product.

Where this applies

- The mentor and student-facing app — foundation + human layer
- Manager and coordinator dashboards — foundation + structured layer
- Pitch decks, reports, and external documents — foundation throughout, human layer in any narrative sections
- Print and merchandise — icon-led, navy-dominant, minimal color

This guide reflects decisions made to date. Visual choices — especially color reception and the logo's symbolic read — should be treated as a working draft, to be validated with real mentors and students during discovery, not as a final, untestable artifact.